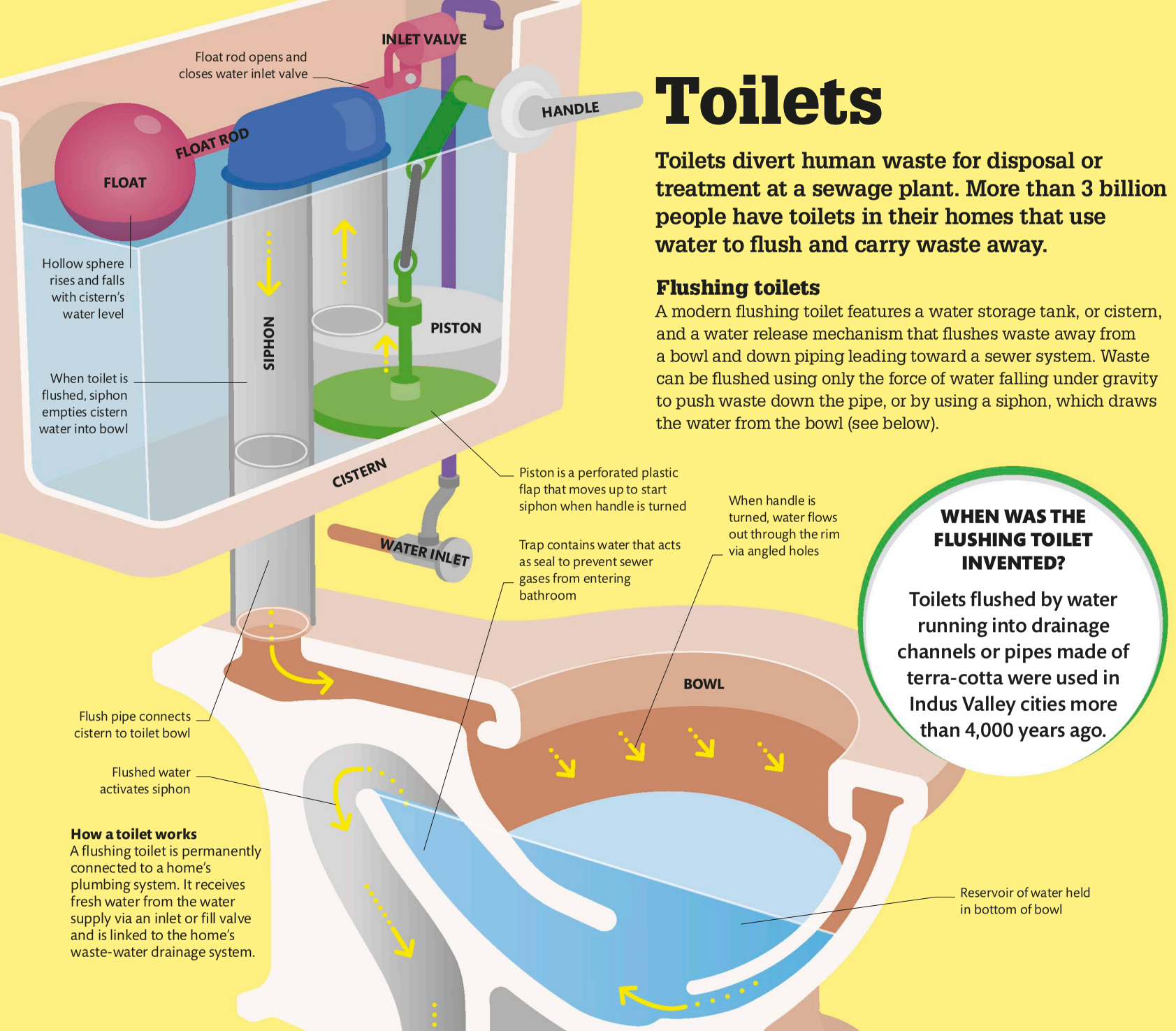
Toilets

Toilets divert human waste for disposal or treatment at a sewage plant. More than 3 billion people have toilets in their homes that use water to flush and carry waste away.

Flushing toilets

A modern flushing toilet features a water storage tank, or cistern, and a water release mechanism that flushes waste away from a bowl and down piping leading toward a sewer system. Waste can be flushed using only the force of water falling under gravity to push waste down the pipe, or by using a siphon, which draws the water from the bowl (see below).



How a toilet works
A flushing toilet is permanently connected to a home's plumbing system. It receives fresh water from the water supply via an inlet or fill valve and is linked to the home's waste-water drainage system.

WHEN WAS THE FLUSHING TOILET INVENTED?

Toilets flushed by water running into drainage channels or pipes made of terra-cotta were used in Indus Valley cities more than 4,000 years ago.